

8-Week Software Engineering Internship Plan

A hands-on track focused on shipping two internal tools end to end — not just tutorials.

What this internship is for

Over eight weeks, the intern will design, build, test, and document two internal products. The aim is to leave with working software and a clear sense of how production systems are put together — architecture, APIs, data, auth, integrations, and deployment — not a pile of unfinished demos.

1. Engineering Performance & Reporting Platform

Automates how we pull GitHub activity into weekly performance reports, with AI-assisted summaries and an approval path for managers.

2. No-Code AI / ML Learning Platform

A guided environment where team members can try classification, regression, time-series, and LLM workflows without writing code first.

Recommended stack

Keep the stack consistent across both products so time goes into product work, not tooling churn.

BACKEND

Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, SQLAlchemy, Alembic, Redis, Celery (or equivalent background jobs), JWT auth

FRONTEND

Vue 3 + Nuxt, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, TanStack Query, Zod for form/API validation

INTEGRATIONS

GitHub API (REST + webhooks), OpenAI API for report generation and learning assistants

DEVOPS

Docker, Docker Compose, GitHub Actions for CI

Frontend stays on Vue/Nuxt for both products. Shared UI patterns and components where it makes sense.

Week-by-week plan

WEEK 1

Foundations & authentication service

Settle into the repo workflow (GitHub Flow, small PRs, review comments) and stand up the shared backend skeleton: FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Docker Compose, and a basic config story with environment variables.

Main build for the week: registration, login, JWT access + refresh tokens, and simple role checks. Swagger should stay current as endpoints land.

Done when: Auth endpoints work end to end in Docker, the DB is wired up, and the intern can walk through the login/refresh flow in a short demo.

WEEK 2

Reporting platform backend

Expand the API around the reporting domain: users, teams, organisations, reports, approvals, and comments. Focus on clean module boundaries (routes → services → data access), validation, sensible errors, and pagination/filtering where lists will get large.

Spend real time on the schema — relationships between users, teams, reports, and approvals should be deliberate, not bolted on later. Alembic migrations from day one.

Done when: CRUD for the core modules is in place, an ERD has been reviewed with the team, and unit tests cover the critical service paths.

WEEK 3

GitHub sync & scheduled jobs

Connect engineer accounts to GitHub (OAuth), then pull repositories, commits, pull requests, reviews, and issues into our database. Handle rate limits properly; don't pretend the happy path is enough.

Add webhooks where useful and a daily sync job (Celery/cron) so data doesn't depend on someone clicking "refresh." A simple engineer activity view on top of the synced data closes the loop.

Done when: Live GitHub data syncs on a schedule and shows up correctly in the dashboard for at least one connected account.

WEEK 4

AI-assisted reports

Use the synced activity to draft weekly summaries — manager-facing, exec-lite, and next-week goals. Prompts should produce structured output we can edit, not a black box dump into the database.

Wire the draft → edit → approve path, plus PDF export and email notification when a report is ready for review. Keep an eye on tokens and failure modes (empty weeks, sparse activity, API timeouts).

Done when: A report can be generated from real GitHub data, edited, approved, exported to PDF, and the reviewer gets notified.

WEEK 5

No-code AI platform — shell & onboarding

Start the second product. Ship a usable Nuxt frontend: dashboard, learning paths, CSV upload with preview, and a few sample datasets so people aren't stuck without data on day one.

Sketch the canvas / module navigation early, even if workflows are still light. Onboarding should get a new user to their first dataset without a walkthrough from engineering.

Done when: The UI is navigable, uploads work, and a first-time user can get through onboarding without hand-holding.

WEEK 6

Visual ML workflows

Implement guided workflows for the common cases we care about: tabular prediction from CSV, basic image classification, a simple time-series forecast, and an LLM playground (prompt testing, captioning, Q&A).

Preprocessing and feature choices should be visible in the UI — the point is learning, not hiding every step behind “Run.” If time allows, a side-by-side comparison of two workflow runs is a nice extra, not a requirement.

Done when: At least one full path (data in → train/run → result) works for tabular and one other modality.

WEEK 7

From canvas to code

Bridge the gap between the no-code view and real code. From a completed workflow, generate readable Python the learner can inspect — classification, regression, time series, image, or LLM path depending on what they built.

Useful extras: side-by-side canvas vs code, export to a notebook or script, basic charts/metrics, and a short experiment history so runs aren’t lost when the tab closes.

Done when: Several workflow types can produce exportable code that actually runs, and the mapping from canvas steps to code is clear in a demo.

WEEK 8

Hardening, docs, and handoff

Treat both products like something the team might keep running: Compose setups, CI on GitHub Actions, logging, basic security checks, and tests tightened around the risky paths (auth, sync, report generation).

Finish with docs people will actually use — setup guide, short architecture notes, API overview, and a user-facing walkthrough for each product. Close with a presentation covering design choices, what broke, what you’d do next, and a live demo of both tools.

Done when: Both apps run from documented Compose setups, CI is green on main paths, and the final demo stands on its own without a “you had to be there” setup.

Deliverables at a glance

Week	Primary deliverable
1	Dockerised auth API with PostgreSQL and JWT (access + refresh)
2	Reporting domain APIs + reviewed database design
3	GitHub OAuth, sync jobs, and engineer activity view
4	AI report drafts, approval flow, PDF export, notifications
5	Learning platform UI, uploads, and first-run onboarding
6	Visual workflows for tabular + at least one other task type
7	Canvas → Python/notebook export with run history

Week	Primary deliverable
8	Deployment docs, CI, and final presentation

Weekly rhythm

- Short daily check-in (about 15 minutes)
- One pairing session each week
- PR reviews before anything merges
- Architecture check-in mid-week when design is shifting
- Aim for solid test coverage on new backend work (target ~80% on touched modules)
- Friday demo to engineering leads
- Brief notes on what was learned / blocked
- Quick retro + plan for the following week

What “good” looks like by week 8

1. Can design and ship FastAPI services with a clear service layer and migrations.
2. Comfortable building Vue/Nuxt UIs in TypeScript that talk to those APIs reliably.
3. Can model relational data for multi-team reporting without painting us into a corner.
4. Has shipped a real GitHub integration (OAuth, sync, rate-limit awareness).
5. Can build LLM features that are editable and reviewable — not one-shot magic output.
6. Has a working starter for no-code ML learning (tabular + at least one other modality).
7. Can explain how a visual workflow maps to generated Python a beginner could read.
8. Leaves both apps runnable via Docker, with CI and docs another engineer can follow.